

against something that you shouldn't be doing (going off at a tangent, perhaps), or big, bold lettering to indicate tasks that you should prioritise. The bottom-line is that items that need attention should look the part and grab attention.

Let's start with formatting fonts: just hover over a node to select it (it'll get highlighted in grey when you do) and use the font selector in the toolbar above to change the style to your whim. To change the font colour, right-click on the



A suitably-formatted mind map. It's probably a good thing you can only see this in black and white

node and go to Format > Node Color. Notice that the Format menu lets you also select a node background colour, edge colour and edge styles. If you'd like your nodes to be bubbles rather than the somewhat free text they are by default, right-click on them and select Format > Bubble. Every child node henceforth will also be a bubble.

FreeMind also comes with its own pre-configured styles, called Physical Styles - they're nothing special, really, but they ~are~ bound to the function keys, and if you familiarise yourself with them, you can just hit [F5] for hot topics instead of wondering what style you're going to apply next, for instance. Pretty handy.

Finally, you can assign icons to nodes, which is where the toolbar on the left comes into the picture. FreeMind's collection of icons covers many conceivable scenarios that you want to use them in - Stop signs, reminders, e-mail addresses, even priority levels. Just click on the respective icon to add it to your node; you can add as many as you like. To remove icons, click on the red cross at